

JC Penney ... now subject[s] garments to tough tests for color matching, fabric shrinkage, and pilling.... When it comes to quality control Penney's is more demanding than any of the department stores (Teri Agins, "Why Cheap Clothes Are Getting More Respect," The Wall Street Journal, Oct. 16, 1995, pp. B1, B3).

Keep in mind that moths, cigar ashes, and other hazards do not care how much you paid for your wool suit. They do not understand the full meaning of *bespoke*. They are not interested in the fact that a suit with the same label was also worn by Dickens, de Gaulle, and Churchill. Nor do they care if your suits ever generate dividends or capital gains. But they can certainly ruin your investment portfolio of suits.

THEN CERTAINLY FOOTWEAR

Let us return to our proposed TV program. Mr. Lucas is still on stage. What type of shoes does Johnny Lucas purchase? The TV audience, if any are still tuned in, will again be surprised by his answer. Johnny, like most millionaires, does not buy high-priced footwear. About half the millionaires surveyed reported that they had never spent \$140 or more for a pair of shoes. One in four had never spent more than \$100. Only about one in ten had spent over \$300. If not millionaires, then who is keeping the high-priced shoe manufacturers and dealers in business? Certainly some millionaires purchase expensive shoes. But for every millionaire in the "highest price paid" category of over \$300, there are at least eight nonmillionaires.

But what does the popular press tell us? The press sensationalizes that very small proportion of Americans who purchase expensive shoes and related artifacts. Consider this news story about boxing promoter Don King, who spent two hours shopping for shoes in Atlanta. During that time, Mr. King purchased 110 pairs of shoes from one store, for which he paid \$64,100, tax included. His purchase topped the previous sales record for the store, held by Magic Johnson, who spent \$35,000 during one visit. Mr. King's record purchase translates into an average of \$582.73 per pair. How much did Mr. King pay for his most expensive pair? It was reported that a pair of alligator loafers cost him \$850 (Jeff